

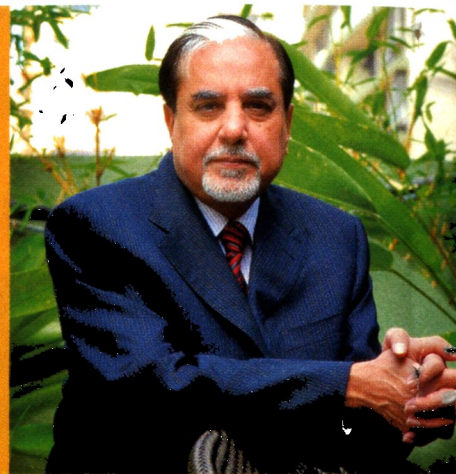
3 Blending Success Ratan Tata

In 2000, Tata Tea took over Tetley Tea, the company which was twice Tata Tea's size and had introduced the world to tea bags, for £271 million via a leverage buyout. The move turned the company into the world's second-largest tea marketer. While Tata was strong on the production front, Tetley's strengths lay in marketing. At the time of acquisition, The two companies were merged a year later. The Tetley brand name would give Tata Tea access to markets in Saudi Arabia, Iran, Iraq, and the CIS countries, said the company's vice-chairman, R.K. Krishna Kumar, whose mandate for the acquisition was simple: to eliminate the competition, Unilever. "Tata Tea's transformation is an eloquent example of the group becoming market-focused and consumer-centric" (INDIA TODAY, February 2003).

4 Packing a Punch Subhash Chandra

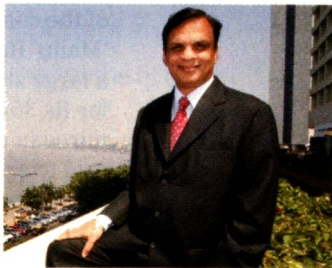
In 2000, Essel Packaging owned by Subhash Chandra of Zee acquired Switzerland's Propack AG, and became the world's largest producer of laminated tubes. The cash and stock deal resulted in Essel issuing 6.68 million shares to Propack's promoters, in addition to a cash payment of \$11 million. In subsequent years, Essel Propack continued acquisitions across the world and ventured into manufacturing of medical devices with the acquisition of Tapro Inc., US and Avalon Medical Services, Singapore.

RAGHU RAI



5 V for Victory Venugopal Dhoot

In an interview to INDIA TODAY in October 2003, Videocon Industries chairman Venugopal Dhoot had said, "You have seen the 'Intel Inside' badges on computers and soon you will see 'Videocon Inside' on most durables." In less than two years from then, he acquired French electronics company Thomson SA's colour picture tube manufacturing business for Rs 1,280 crore and just over a week later, Swedish major AB Electrolux's Indian subsidiary Electrolux Kelvinator.



SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE

AP



6 Going West Ratan Tata

The year 2006 proved to be the 'year of buyouts' by Indian companies. In October, Tata Steel acquired Anglo-Dutch firm Corus Group for Rs 60,000 crore. "Many thought our bid was audacious but this was really the commencement of our global strategy," Ratan Tata said at a press conference. "Tata's victory symbolises the new confidence of Indian corporates and its growing global ambitions." (INDIA TODAY, February 2007) In line with this, the group acquired automaker Ford's Jaguar and Land Rover car brands for \$2.3 billion in March 2008, amid severe opposition from Jaguar's dealers in the UK and US which expressed concern about selling a luxury brand to an Indian company.

WHEN TATA TEA TOOK OVER TETLEY TEA, WHICH WAS TWICE ITS SIZE, IT SHOWED INDIA HAD ARRIVED.